



THE 10 BEST STARTING HANDS

1 AA	2 KK
3 QQ	4 JJ
5 TT	6 AKs
7 AKo	8 AQs
9 KQs	10 AJs

Almost always raise/re-raise these from any seat.

s = suited (same suit) · o = offsuit · T = Ten

HAND TIERS

PREMIUM	AA, KK, QQ, JJ, AKs, AKo Raise from any position, re-raise aggressively
STRONG	TT–88, AQ, AJs, ATs, KQs Raise from most positions, slow down vs heavy 3-bets
SPECULATIVE	Small pairs 77–22 · suited connectors (JTs, T9s, 98s) · suited aces (A2s–A9s) Mostly late position; need cheap flops + position
TRASH · FOLD	Weak offsuit aces (A4o) · king-rag (K3o) · low offsuit junk Fold preflop — these cost chips every session

OPENING CHART BY POSITION (9-MAX)

POSITION	OPEN RANGE	KEY HANDS TO ADD
UTG Early	Top ~13% 	TT+, AJs+, AKo, KQs
MP Middle	Top ~17% 	Add 88, 99, ATs, KJs, QJs, JTs
CO Cutoff	Top ~27% 	Add 55–77, A9s+, KTs+, suited connectors (T9s, 98s)
BTN Button	Top ~43% 	Add 22–44, A2s+, suited broadways, weaker offsuit hands

The later you act, the wider you open. **6-max**: every seat plays ~one position wider.

 ~80% of hands you're dealt should be folded preflop.	 Suited adds only ~2 points of equity — position matters more.	 Worst hand: 7-2 offsuit .
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 Full guide + interactive chart

holdemmaster.com/en/blog/holdem-starting-hands-chart